

LEGENDARY

MARVEL STUDIOS

WHAT IF...?

RULE BOOK



Overview

Welcome to the *What If...?* set of *Legendary®: a Marvel Deck-Building Game!* This set is based on the hit Disney+ animated series “*Marvel: What If...?*” which is part of the Marvel Cinematic Universe and inspired by the classic *Marvel What If...?* comic series. Uatu the Watcher looks across the parallel realities of the multiverse, witnessing horrifying turning points in different dimensions:

- What if Killmonger betrayed and murdered both T’Challa and Tony Stark?
- What if the noble Avengers became flesh-eating zombies?
- What if Ultron gained all six Infinity Stones, conquered his Earth and then invaded the entire multiverse?

To overcome them, the Watcher breaks his oath not to interfere, gathering Heroes from alternate dimensions where their fates hinged on key turning points of their own:

- What if Peggy Carter took the Super Soldier Serum instead of Steve Rogers, gaining all the powers of Captain America?
- What if T’Challa was kidnapped from Earth to become Star-Lord, instead of becoming Black Panther?
- What if Doctor Strange gave into temptation and stole the souls of demons to resurrect his lost love?

Every time you play *Legendary®*, the game itself fights back against you, with a different dark Mastermind pursuing a different evil Scheme. Only you can stop them by recruiting Heroes, fighting Villains, and eventually challenging the Mastermind themselves. Each player (from 1-5 players) starts with their own deck of basic Hero cards. At the start of your turn, you play the top card of the Villain Deck, showing how Villains invade the city, capture Bystanders, and create special events. Then you play Hero cards from your hand to generate Attack, Recruit, and special abilities. You use Attack to fight Villains. You use Recruit to get stronger Heroes to improve your deck.

Whenever your deck runs out of cards and you need more, you shuffle your discard pile to make a new deck, including all the new Heroes you recruited. This way your deck gets stronger and stronger over time. Build up enough Attack and you can fight the evil Mastermind! But be careful: if the players don’t defeat that evil genius quickly enough, then the Mastermind will complete their dark Scheme, win the game for evil, and all players lose!



What's New in *What If...?*

(Skip this section if this is your first time playing *Legendary*®.)

This set is **100% compatible** with all *Legendary*® expansions. **If you are already comfortable with the *Legendary*® Deck Building Game** then you don't need to read this *What If...?* rulebook. You can find rules for the keyword abilities in the *What If...?* set on page 16.

If you are familiar with *Legendary*®: here are some key updates.

- **There is an updated quantity of card stacks to use for each number of players**, to give games with a larger number of players more time to win. (page 6)
- 4-5 player games now use a **"Warmup Round"** to reduce early Villain escapes. (page 8)
- There is now a **"Starting HQ Mulligan"** if multiple cards in the starting HQ cost 7 or more. (page 7)
- **Solo mode** no longer plays an extra card from the Villain Deck after each Master Strike. In solo, 2 Henchmen start the game already in the city. The solo mode Villain Deck now gives about 4 extra turns before running out. (page 23)
- New **"Alternate Game Modes"** (page 25)

How to Win

Players must work together to fight the evil Mastermind four times. Each fight takes one of the Mastermind's four face down "Tactic" cards. When the Mastermind has no more Tactics, the players have won the game! Fighting Villains and rescuing Bystanders along the way earns each player additional Victory Points. If the Mastermind is defeated, then all players win a group victory, and the player with the most Victory Points is the most *Legendary* Hero of all!

How the Evil Mastermind Wins

Unlike other games, in *Legendary*® the game itself fights back against the players. The evil Mastermind, like Hank Pym Yellowjacket or Ultron Infinity, isn't played by a player. Instead, the game itself plays the part of the Mastermind.

The Mastermind works to accomplish an evil Scheme throughout the game. Every Scheme card has an **"Evil Wins"** condition, which tells you how the Mastermind completes their Scheme. If the evil Scheme is completed, then the Mastermind wins the game for evil, and all the players lose! If this happens, then the Victory Points don't matter and no player wins.

Your First Game

For your first game, follow the setup rules on page 4, using the specific card stacks listed there instead of choosing card stacks at random.

After your first game, every session of *Legendary*® uses different Heroes, Villains, Mastermind, and Scheme, so there are always new challenges to confront and new combinations to explore. Any Mastermind can use any Scheme, and they interact with each other in interesting ways, so there are countless dangerous scenarios to master.



Your First Game - Cards To Use

Mastermind: Hank Pym Yellowjacket

Scheme: Collect an Interstellar Zoo

Heroes:

1 player: Apocalyptic Black Widow, Gamora Destroyer of Thanos, Killmonger Spec Ops,

2-4 players: Also add Party Thor, Captain Carter

5 players: Also add Uatu the Watcher

Villain Groups for the Villain Deck:

1 player: Intergalactic Party Animals, Giants of Jotunheim (2 Giants in Villain deck, and 2 start in city)

2 players: Also add Strange's Demons (all 10 Giants of Jotunheim in Villain Deck, and none in the city)

3 players: Also add Black Order Guards

4 players: Also add Zombie Avengers and Ultron Sentries

5 players: Also add Rival Overlords



Game Setup

Player Decks

Give each player their own personal 12-card deck, made of these cards:

- 8 S.H.I.E.L.D. Agents
- 4 S.H.I.E.L.D. Troopers



Always Available Decks

Put each of these decks on their spaces on the playmat. Use all the cards you own of each type:

- S.H.I.E.L.D. Officers
- Bystanders
- Wounds

Special Bystanders are shuffled in with the other Bystanders. Decks of all identical cards can stay face up. Decks containing different cards should be shuffled face down.

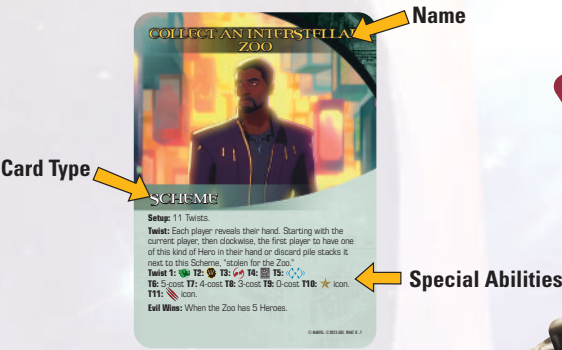


Mastermind and Scheme

- Pick 1 **Mastermind** at random. Put it on the Mastermind space on the playmat. Tuck its 4 **matching Mastermind Tactic** cards underneath it, face down in random order.
 - All the Masterminds in this set are double-sided, with a normal side and a harder “Epic” side. For most games, you’ll want to use the normal (non-Epic) side.



- Pick **1 Scheme** card at random. Put it face up on the Scheme space. Each Scheme card has a **“Setup:”** that specifies how many “Twists” to use. Put that many “Scheme Twist” cards onto the Villain Deck space. Some Schemes also change the number of Heroes or Villain Groups to use or specify other special rules.



Villain Deck

- Add all **5 Master Strike** cards to the Villain Deck.
- Add **Villain Groups** and **Henchman Groups** to the Villain Deck. A “Villain Group” is a set of eight Villain cards that work together, like “Zombie Avengers” or “Strange’s Demons.” Each Villain card lists its Villain Group under its card name.



To Add Villain Groups

The more players you have in the game, the more Villain Groups you use, as shown in this game setup table:

Players	Villain Groups	Henchman Groups	Bystanders	Heroes
1	1	1* (2 cards in deck, 2 cards in city)	1	3
2	2	1	2	5
3	3	1	8	5
4	4	2	8	5
5	5	2	16	6

- Each Mastermind card says that the Mastermind **“Always Leads”** a particular Villain Group or Henchman Group. Include it as one of the groups you add to the Villain Deck. Pick the remaining Villain and Henchman Groups at random.
- For each Villain Group you pick, add all 8 Villain cards from that Villain Group to the Villain Deck.
- For each Henchman Group, add the 10 identical Henchman Villain cards from that Henchman Group to the Villain Deck.

- ***In 1-player solo games only:** Add only two cards from the chosen Henchman Group to the Villain Deck. Two more cards from that same Henchman Group enter the city before your first turn. Do not use the remaining 6 cards. (See page 23.)

To Add Bystanders

- Check the game setup table (page 6) to see how many cards from the Bystander Deck to add to the Villain Deck. (By random chance some of the cards might be Special Bystanders.)



Hero Deck

There are eight different Heroes in *Legendary®: What If...?*. There are fourteen cards for each of these Heroes. Make the Hero Deck this way:

- Check the game setup table (page 6) to see how many Heroes you should add. Pick that number of Heroes from all the Heroes you have. For each of those Heroes, add all 14 cards for that Hero to the Hero Deck.



Completing Setup

- Shuffle the Hero Deck. Put it face down on the Hero Deck space. Put 5 cards from the Hero Deck face up into the **5 HQ spaces**.
- Shuffle the Villain Deck. Put it face down on the Villain Deck space.
- Each player shuffles their own personal deck and draws a hand of **6 cards** from it.

Starting HQ Mulligan

If there are at least two cards in the starting HQ that cost 7 or more, then all players can agree to “mulligan” those HQ spaces like this: Set aside all cards that cost 7 or more from the HQ. Refill those HQ spaces, also setting aside any other Heroes that cost 7 or more that appear during any of these refills. Once the HQ is full, shuffle the set-aside Heroes back into the Hero Deck. Do this only during game setup – you can’t mulligan once the game has already started. This helps avoid overly expensive starting HQs.

How to Play

Choose a random player to go first. Players take turns in clockwise order. On your turn, do 3 things:

1. Play the top card of the Villain Deck.
2. Play cards from your hand, using them to fight and recruit.
3. Discard your hand and draw 6 new cards.

Step 1) Play the Top Card of the Villain Deck

Play the top card of the Villain Deck, face up. What you do with that card depends on what kind of card it is. There are four kinds of cards in the Villain Deck: Villains, Bystanders, Master Strikes, and Scheme Twists.

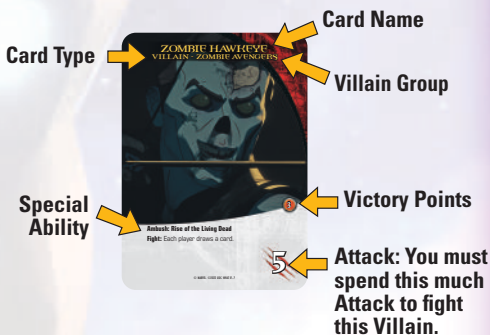
4-5 Players: Warmup Round

Note: In 4 and 5 player games only, there is a “Warmup Round” where on each player’s first turn, they **do not** play a card from the Villain Deck. On every turn after that, play the top card of the Villain Deck as normal. This gives larger player groups more time to get their decks going before the Villains start invading.

If the Villain Deck Card is a Villain:

That Villain invades the city!

Here are the different parts of a Villain card. (Note: “Henchman Villains” are Villains too.)



The Villain Enters the City

Move the new Villain into the city space closest to the Villain Deck. That city space is labeled “Sewers.” Villains in the city are always face up.



Push Other Villains Forward if Necessary

Each of the 5 city spaces can only hold one Villain. Whenever a Villain enters a city space, if there’s already another Villain there, that existing Villain gets pushed forward one space to make room. So a single Villain entering the city sometimes causes a chain reaction of several Villains getting pushed forward.

- Remember: Only push a Villain forward if it needs to move to make room for another Villain entering that space.



A Villain Might Escape

If a Villain gets pushed off the final, fifth city space, then that Villain “escapes” the city and goes into the Escape Pile on the playmat, face up. When a Villain escapes, follow these steps:

1) The escaping Villain “KOs” a Hero that costs 6 or less from the HQ. The player whose turn it is chooses which of those Heroes gets KO’d. Put that Hero into a shared, face up “KO pile” off to the side, knocking it out of the game.

- Immediately flip a new Hero from the Hero Deck, face up, to fill the empty space in the HQ. (Whenever an HQ space is empty, immediately refill it this way.)

2) If the escaping Villain had any captured Bystanders, then each player must discard a card from their hand as a penalty for failing to rescue the Bystanders. After all, what kind of Superheroes let innocent Bystanders get carried away by Villains? Those Bystanders stay in the Escape Pile.

- Note: Each player only discards one card when a Villain carries away Bystanders, no matter how many Bystanders it carried away.

3) If the escaping Villain has an “Escape” effect on its card, do what it says.



The New Villain Might Ambush

If the new Villain has an “Ambush” effect written on its card, do what it says now. Remember:

- Make sure that the newly entering Villain has **fully moved into the Sewers** (pushing any other Villains as necessary) before doing its Ambush ability.
- If another Villain was pushed out of the city and escaped when this new Villain entered the city, handle all the Escape effects for the escaping Villain **before** handling any Ambush effect for the new Villain.



Ambush: Another Villain captures a Bystander.

If the Villain Deck Card is a Bystander:

The innocent Bystander is captured by a Villain! Tuck the Bystander (face up) under the Villain in the city that's closest to the Villain Deck. If there are no Villains in the city, then the Bystander is captured by the Mastermind. Make sure the Bystander pokes out a bit so players can see it.

- Whenever a Villain with any Bystanders moves to a new city space, it carries all those Bystanders along with it to the new space.
- It's up to the players to rescue Bystanders! When a player fights a Villain or Mastermind with any Bystanders, that player rescues all Bystanders under that Villain or Mastermind and puts them into their personal Victory Pile. Each Bystander is worth 1 Victory Point, so the more Bystanders you rescue, the more Victory Points you earn. Some **"Special Bystanders"** also say they give you extra rewards "When you rescue this Bystander."



If the Villain Deck Card is a Master Strike:

A Master Strike represents the evil Mastermind emerging from their lair to get their hands dirty and smash the Heroes themselves. Each Mastermind has their own specific Master Strike. When a Master Strike is played from the Villain Deck, look at the **"Master Strike"** effect on the Mastermind card and do what it says. Put the Master Strike in the KO pile (unless the effect says to put it somewhere else).



If the Villain Deck Card is a Scheme Twist:

A Scheme Twist card represents the evil Scheme moving forward towards victory for the Mastermind. Every Scheme works in a completely different way, with its Scheme Twists doing a specific thing related to that Scheme. When a Scheme Twist card is played, look at the **"Twist"** effect on the main Scheme card and do what it says. (Some Schemes say they do something special when **"Twist 1"** or **"Twists 4-6"** come up.) Put the Scheme Twist in the KO pile (unless the Scheme tells you to put it somewhere else).



Note: Villains in the city **don't** get pushed forward when the card played from the Villain Deck is a Bystander, Master Strike, or Scheme Twist. Resist any temptation to push Villains forward before revealing the card from the Villain Deck!

"Gaining" Wounds and Other Cards

Some card effects say that a player "gains" a particular card. That means put that card into that player's discard pile. For example, "gain a Wound" means put a card from the Wound Deck into your discard pile. (See page 20 for more details on Wounds.)

Step 2) Play Cards from Your Hand, Using Them to Fight and Recruit

The only types of cards that can typically be in your hand are Heroes and Wounds. Here are the different parts of a Hero card:



After you play the top card of the Villain Deck, it's time to play the cards from your hand. Some of your cards produce "Attack" points that let you fight Villains. Other cards produce "Recruit" points that let you gain more Heroes. Many cards also give you powerful special abilities.

- Play each card in your hand in any order, one at a time.
 - Each time you play a card, do what that card says.
 - You get any **Attack** points listed in its Attack icon.
 - You also get any **Recruit** points listed in its Recruit icon.
- Keep the cards you play in front of you until the end of your turn.
- To make it easier to count up your Attack Points and Recruit Points, you can line up all the Attack icons as you go, so that you can read all the Attack Points in a row. You can do the same with lining up your Recruit icons.
- You can play all your cards, building up a pool of Attack Points and Recruit Points, before deciding which enemies to fight and which Heroes to recruit.



Numbers Like 2+ or 2✳:

Some cards have numbers like "2+" inside their Recruit icon. The "2" means that you always get at least 2 Recruit from that card. The "+" symbol means that you might get even more Recruit based on what the card says in its special ability. Heroes' Attack icons and Enemies' Attack icons can have numbers like "2+" too, working the same way.

Likewise, some Hero and Enemy cards in other sets have a number with an asterisk like "2✳" inside one of their icons. This means the card's special abilities tell you something especially important about how to use that card's Attack, Recruit, or Cost, so it's crucial to check its special abilities. (It doesn't mean multiplication or a variable.)

Superpower Abilities

- Some cards have a **Superpower** ability with a Hero Class (color) icon and a colon, like : You get **+1** .
- You may use that Superpower ability **only if you have already played another card of that color earlier in your turn.**
 - A card's color is shown in the Hero Class icon in the card's upper left, and also in the color of the card's border. (Each Hero has a "Rare" card with no border. You can see a rare card's color by checking the Hero Class icon.)
 - Some Superpowers use a team icon like Guardians of the Multiverse  instead of a Hero Class icon. These work the same way as Superpowers that use color icons. A card's team icon is in the card's upper-left corner.
- Important:** You can only use a card's Superpower ability once, even if you played multiple cards of that color that turn.
 - However, a few Superpower abilities will explicitly tell you to count a number of cards played earlier in the turn, like : You get **+1**  for each other  Hero you played this turn."
- You don't have to use a Superpower ability if you don't want to.
- The more Heroes of the same color or same team you recruit, the more often you will be able to use your Superpower abilities! A deck focusing on one or two colors can be very powerful.
- Some Superpower Abilities require things like " :" or "  cards or played a  card and played a  card earlier in the turn.



TOTAL



Example of Superpower Abilities

- Killmonger's "Violence Leaves Scars" card, shown here, always gives you 3 Attack when you play it, even if you don't have any other green ("Strength Hero") cards.
- But if you have already played another green card earlier in the turn, then you may use Killmonger's Superpower ability to get an additional 2 Attack (there are 2 different Villain Groups in your Victory Pile), so that gives you 7 Attack in total.
- The green card you played earlier in the turn could be a green Party Thor card, another green Killmonger card, or even another copy of Violence Leaves Scars.
- If you play two Violence Leaves Scars cards as your first two cards of the turn, you won't get to use the Superpower ability for the first Violence Leaves Scars card you play this turn, but you will get to use the Superpower for the second Violence Leaves Scars card you play this turn. So you would get 8 Attack total.

Fighting Villains and Recruiting Heroes

In between playing cards from your hand, and/or after you've played all your cards, you can fight any number of Villains and recruit any number of Heroes. You can play cards, fight, and recruit any number of times in any order in the same turn.

How to Fight a Villain

As you play Heroes from your hand, you generate a pool of Attack Points. You can spend these to fight Villains in the city, one at a time. You can only fight a Villain if you have at least as many Attack Points remaining as that Villain's Attack number. You don't have to match up specific Heroes you play against specific Villains. It doesn't matter which city space holds the Villain.

To fight a Villain:

- 1) **Spend Attack Points equal to that Villain's Attack to put that Villain into your personal Victory Pile.** (Also rescue any Bystanders underneath, placing them into your Victory Pile.)
- 2) **If the Villain card has a "Fight" effect on it, do what it says. Also do any "When you rescue this" effects on any Bystanders you rescued this way. (Do these Fight and Rescue effects in any order.)**

You can also fight the Mastermind. (See page 14)

KO

Many card effects tell you to "KO" a card, meaning "knock out." Put that card into the shared, face up "KO Pile" off to the side of the playmat. These cards are permanently knocked out of the game.

- Getting your starting S.H.I.E.L.D. Heroes KO'd is actually often helpful, since it means you will draw your more powerful Heroes more often, instead of drawing the weaker S.H.I.E.L.D. Heroes.
- Note: If a card says to KO "one of your Heroes," that can be a Hero you've already played this turn or a Hero still in your hand. If you KO a Hero you already played this turn, you still get to use the Recruit, Attack, and special abilities that Hero produced.

Victory Piles

- Each player has their own personal Victory Pile. It holds all the Villains they have fought and all the Bystanders they have rescued.
- Villains and Bystanders are not shuffled into your deck.
- Keep your Victory Pile horizontal so you don't accidentally mix it up with your discard pile.
- At the end of the game, Villains and Bystanders in your Victory Pile are worth the Victory Points shown on their cards.

Your Victory Pile



Your Deck



Discard Pile

How to Recruit a Hero

As you play Heroes from your hand, you generate a pool of Recruit Points. You can spend these to recruit Heroes from the HQ, one at a time. You can only recruit a Hero if you have at least as many Recruit Points remaining as that Hero's cost. The "HQ" area of the playmat has five spaces, which always contain exactly five Heroes, all face up.

To recruit a Hero:

- 1) **Spend Recruit equal to that Hero's cost to "gain" that Hero and put it into your discard pile.** A Hero's cost is in its lower-right corner. When your deck runs out and you shuffle your discard pile to make a new deck, you will soon draw that new Hero and be able to use their abilities.
 - 2) **Then refill the empty space in the HQ with a new card from the Hero Deck, face up.** Whenever there is an empty space in the HQ for any reason, refill that space immediately this way. You can even recruit a Hero, see what new Hero appears in its place from the Hero Deck, and then potentially recruit that new Hero too, if you have enough Recruit Points.
- You can always spend **3 Recruit Points** to recruit a **S.H.I.E.L.D. Officer** from the Officer Deck.

Step 3) Discard Your Hand and Draw 6 New Cards

- At the end of your turn, put all the cards you played this turn into your discard pile, face up.
- Also discard any cards in your hand that you didn't play this turn.
- Then draw 6 new cards from your deck. If your deck runs out and you still have to draw more cards, shuffle your discard pile into a new face down deck, then draw the rest of the cards you need.
- (Don't shuffle your discard pile into a new deck until your deck has completely run out and you still need to draw or reveal more cards.)

Masterminds

A Mastermind is a diabolical archenemy that pursues an evil Scheme and leads the other Villains. A player can choose to fight the Mastermind instead of fighting a Villain. Like any other fight, you have to spend Attack Points equal to the Mastermind's Attack to fight that Mastermind.



Mastermind Tactics

Masterminds use different abilities during fights, represented by "Mastermind Tactic" cards. All four of a Mastermind's Tactics have the same Attack number, but they each have different "Fight" effects.

To fight a Mastermind:

- 1) **Spend Attack Points equal to the Mastermind's Attack. Take a random card from the face down Tactics underneath the Mastermind and put that Tactic into your Victory Pile.** It's worth several Victory Points. (Also rescue any Bystanders the Mastermind was holding, putting them all into your Victory Pile.)
- 2) **Do what the "Fight" effect on the Tactic card says. Also do any "When you rescue this" effects on any Bystanders you rescued this way. (Do these Fight and Rescue effects in any order.)**
 - These effects may give you a reward, cause the Mastermind to hit each other player with an unwelcome effect, or power up the Mastermind for the future.
 - If a Tactic's Fight effect somehow increases the Mastermind's Attack number, that will only apply for future fights.



A Mastermind is not truly beaten until all of their Mastermind Tactic cards have been fought by the players. If you draw a great hand that gives you a large pool of Attack Points, you can even fight the Mastermind multiple times in one turn.

End of the Game

Players Win

When the Mastermind has no more Tactic cards under them, the players win the game!

- When fighting the final Mastermind Tactic, the current player still does that Tactic's "Fight" ability. That player may finish the rest of their turn in case they want to fight a few more Villains.
- As soon as the Mastermind has no more Tactics under them, victory is assured, and players will win the game even if the final Tactic's "Fight" ability would achieve the Scheme's "Evil Wins" condition or cause the Hero Deck or Villain Deck to run out.

Evil Wins

Every Scheme card has a part that says "**Evil Wins,**" which tells you how the Mastermind completes their Scheme. If the evil Scheme is completed, then the Mastermind immediately wins the game for evil, and all players lose. Don't finish the turn.

Tied Game

If either the Hero Deck or the Villain Deck ever reaches zero cards, you can finish the current turn as a final chance to win. If you have not won or lost by the end of this turn, then the game ends in a tie between good and evil. The players have successfully survived the Scheme, but they didn't defeat the Mastermind. The player with the most Victory Points wins an individual victory. Be sure to get the Mastermind next time!

- Once the Hero Deck or Villain Deck has reached zero cards, then the game will end at the end of this turn, even if some card effect somehow puts cards back into the empty Hero Deck or Villain Deck.
- Note: If the Scheme says that evil wins "when the Hero Deck runs out" (or Villain Deck), then the game is over as soon as that deck reaches zero cards. You do not finish the turn in that case – evil has already won.

STOP – End of the Core Rules

Now you know all the rules you need to play! You can stop here and play the game. Some cards in *What If* have keyword abilities like **Soulbind** and **Liberate**. If you wish, you can skim the section below about the specific keyword abilities in *What If*, then come back to read their details as they come up in your game. The rest of this rulebook contains additional clarifications, reference material, and other game modes. You can skim through them if a question comes up, or read them later for more details about the game. Go challenge the Mastermind and good luck!

Keyword Abilities

What If...?

This new keyword highlights how a Hero's destiny can pivot on a single crucial choice, with consequences that spill through the rest of that dimension. Some Hero cards say things like **"What If...?:**

You get +3 ★."

- This means **"Choose a Hero Class or Hero Name. Then reveal the top card of your deck, and either put it back on top of your deck or discard it. If the revealed card had the Hero Class or Hero Name you chose, then do the What If effect."**
- What If...? is not allowed to trigger on 0-cost grey starting cards like S.H.I.E.L.D. Agent or S.H.I.E.L.D. Trooper, so don't choose those Hero Names.
- Even if a What If...? ability misses, it's still valuable to be able to choose to put your top card in your discard pile or not. For example, it can give you key information about your top card so you know what to choose with your next What If...? card that turn. Or if the top card is a S.H.I.E.L.D. Agent, you can discard it so you have a chance to hit with your next What If...? ability that turn and so you don't have to draw it next turn.
- If you choose a Hero Name like "Black Widow," that will trigger on any card whose Hero Name is literally "Black Widow" as well as any Hero Name that contains "Black Widow," such as "Apocalyptic Black Widow." However, you have to choose an actual Hero Name. You can't choose just the word "Captain" and trigger on both Captain America and Captain Carter cards, since the single word "Captain" isn't a Hero Name.

Increasing Your Chances with What If...?

There are lots of ways you can increase the chance that your What If...? abilities will work:

- First: There are several cards in this set that let you reveal the top card of your deck or put a card on top of your deck, so that you know what to choose with What If...?.
- Second: You can try focusing your deck on a single Hero Class or single Hero Name.
- Third: Collecting lots of What If...? cards can let you see the top card with the first What If...?, so you know what to guess with the rest of your What If...? abilities that turn.
- Fourth: You can look for ways to KO your 0-cost starter cards and avoid or KO Wounds.

Soulbind

In a maddened drive to save his beloved Christine Palmer, the alternate-dimension variant known as Doctor Strange Supreme binds demons' dark souls to devour their power. Uatu the Watcher and Gamora also make crucial moves to bind certain souls and Infinity Stones. This is represented with the new Soulbind keyword. Some cards say things like "«Soulbind: You get + equal to that Villain's printed Victory Points»"

- This means **"If you have played a «Soulbind» Hero earlier this turn, you may choose a face up Villain card from your Victory Pile, turn it face down, and put it on the bottom of your Victory Pile. If you do, then do the listed Soulbind effect."** At the end of the game when you are counting Victory Points, turn all those face down cards face up again and you can count their Victory Points. But until the end of the game, the face down cards count as not being in your Victory Pile at all.
- This is a great way to stop *Rise of the Living Dead* Villains (described on page 18) from coming back to life out of your Victory Pile. The face down card can't be used for another

Soulbind effect later. The face down card can't help you against *Cross-Dimensional Rampages* (also described on page 18). It doesn't count for effects that count the number of cards or Villains in your Victory Pile. Act as if the face down card is no longer in your Victory Pile at all, until you are counting Victory Points at the end of the game.

- Some cards ask you to Soulbind more specific things, like "Soulbind a Henchman" or "Soulbind six Villains."
- **Using Soulbind is usually optional.** You generally don't have to use Soulbind if you don't want to, whether on a Hero card you played or a Villain you just fought. However, some cards explicitly say that you "must Soulbind," which means you have to do it.

Liberate

Apocalyptic Black Widow hails from the reality where Ultron won, destroyed the other Avengers, and annihilated most of humanity. She realizes that destroying replaceable robotic sentries will never win the war. Instead she devotes herself to specific strikes on two targets: saving human hostages and destroying the Mastermind once and for all. Killmonger, Spec Ops likewise devotes himself to targeted rescue missions and taking out the top of the opposing command structure. This is represented by the new Liberate keyword. Some Hero cards say things like "Liberate 3"

- This means **"You get +3 , usable only against Villains holding Bystanders or the Mastermind."**
- You can use the bonus  against the Mastermind whether it's holding Bystanders or not.
- You can use  that's "only usable against Masterminds" (like Liberate) on additional  that Mastermind abilities ask you to spend, like when Hank Pym Yellowjacket requires extra  to "track him down."

Empowered

This keyword represents Heroes and Villains who draw power from ambient energy, technology, or Superpowers around them. Ultron can famously infect nearby technology to serve his own ends, while tuning his robotic sentries to absorb specific kinds of energy.

- Some Heroes say "you get Empowered by .
- On Villains and Masterminds "Empowered by  means **"This gets +1  for each  card in the HQ."**
- Uatu the Watcher is sometimes Empowered by a specific Hero Name or Hero Team, in the same way.
- As Heroes enter and leave the HQ, an Empowered card can get stronger or weaker. You only check the bonus at the moment you play your Empowered Hero or at the moment you fight the Empowered Enemy.
- One clever move is to recruit a Hero from the HQ at the right time, changing the colors in the HQ to weaken an Empowered Enemy or try to strengthen an Empowered Hero in your hand.
- Abilities that let you put cards from the HQ on the bottom of the Hero Deck are especially useful at manipulating Empowered Heroes or Empowered Villains.

Multiclass Cards

Wakandans like T'Challa (Black Panther) and N'Jadaka (Killmonger) are famously multitalented, combining technology, instinct, subtlety, long-range planning, and pure power. This is represented by having cards with multiple Hero Classes. For T'Challa in particular, his journeys across the galaxy as Star-Lord T'Challa in

the *What If...?* series have only broadened his mastery over an array of skills, represented by all of his cards being Multiclass. A   card counts as both  and . These cards are great at enabling Superpower abilities like “: You get +2 .

Cross-Dimensional Rampage

From a dimension where Loki didn't grow up in Asgard, Thor never learned sacrifice or the value of honor, so all Party Thor cares about is cutting loose with truly earth-shaking celebrations. Gods, monsters, and aliens arrive to attend these festivities until they're a real bash, with Earth in ruins. This is represented with this keyword.

- “Cross-Dimensional Party Rampage” on a Hero or Villain means **“Each player reveals one of their Party Heroes or a Party card in their Victory Pile or gains a Wound.”**
- You can reveal any card that includes the word “Party” in its card name, Hero name, Villain Group name, or Tactics for “Party” Masterminds. This includes any “Party Thor” Hero card or any card from the “Intergalactic Party Animals” Villain Group.
- “Cross-Dimensional Zombie Rampage” and “Cross-Dimensional Demon Rampage” can be blocked by “Zombie” and “Demon” cards in the same way. You can use any card that has “Demon” as any part of its names, including “Demonic Descendant”, “Demonform”, “Cleaving Demonblade”, and so on.
- When a Cross-Dimensional Party Rampage happens, you can choose to gain the Wound, even if you have a Party card that you already played or could otherwise reveal. You might want to gain the Wound if you have cards that benefit from gaining Wounds, or a card that benefits from preventing Wounds.

Rise of the Living Dead

In one terrifying alternate dimension, a zombie plague overtakes the Avengers and eventually all of Earth. These “Zombie Avengers” retain their Superpowers, but have lost all their heroism, craving only the taste of flesh. Even when they are defeated, they will stagger to their feet again unless they are quickly buried. This is represented by Villains with the “Rise of the Living Dead” keyword.

- “Rise of the Living Dead” means **“Each player checks the top card of their Victory Pile. If that card is a Villain with a ‘Rise of the Living Dead’ ability, that Villain reenters the city.”**
- A Villain that reenters the city this way follows the same rules as any other Villain entering the city: First check if a Villain is pushed out to Escape, and resolve any Escape effects. Then do any Ambush abilities for the arriving Villain.
- **However, note that a Villain returning to the city because a “Rise of the Living Dead” ability does NOT itself bring back additional Villains with its own Rise of the Living Dead ability – a single player does NOT do a chain reaction of many Villains returning at once.** However, since each player is affected by Rise of the Living Dead, several Villains might still return when Rise of the Living Dead occurs – a maximum of one returning Villain per player. (This is a change from when this keyword appeared in *Secret Wars*, when chain reactions were allowed. This change affects the old *Secret Wars* expansion cards too.)
- When Rise of the Living Dead happens, it affects each player in order. The player whose turn it is resolves it first, including any potential Escapes, then any Ambush effects. When all of that is complete, then the next player in clockwise order resolves Rise of the Living Dead in the same way.
- So how do you stop Zombies from returning? By burying them deep! After fighting a Villain with Rise of the Living Dead, look for ways to put a card that **doesn't** have Rise of the Living Dead

on top of that zombie Villain, effectively 'burying it.' That way, the next time Rise of the Living Dead happens, nothing will return. You can do this by fighting a Villain that doesn't have Rise of the Living Dead or Mastermind Tactic or rescuing a Bystander. You can also "Soulbind" the Rise of the Living Dead card to bind the zombie's soul and prevent it from ever returning.

- **Mastermind Tactics are never returned by Rise of the Living Dead.** Zombie Scarlet Witch's Tactics say "**Fight:** Before putting this Tactic in your Victory Pile, Rise of the Living Dead." This means that fighting any Tactic with Rise of the Living Dead can return other Rise of the Living Dead Villains to the city. However, the Mastermind Tactics themselves are never returned, even if the top card of your Victory Pile was a different Mastermind Tactic with Rise of the Living Dead.
- If you put a Villain with Bystanders into your Victory Pile, you choose the order that all those cards go into your Victory Pile. So if you fight a Rise of the Living Dead Villain that had Bystanders, it's smart to put the Bystanders on top.

Villains Ascending to Become Additional Masterminds

When some powerful Villains in this set escape, they say that they ascend to become additional Masterminds. This means there are multiple Masterminds in the game!

- Players must defeat all the Masterminds to win.
- When a Master Strike occurs, each Mastermind does its Master Strike ability. The player whose turn it is picks the order.
- If an effect says it does something to "the Mastermind," you pick which Mastermind it affects.
- An ascending Mastermind doesn't have Mastermind Tactics. You only need to fight it once to defeat it and put it into your Victory Pile. Once it's in your Victory Pile, it's considered a Villain card again, not a Mastermind or Tactic card.

Killmonger, Spec Ops - Counting Villain Groups

Killmonger, Spec Ops has some cards that say "You get **+1**  for each different Villain Group in your Victory Pile." Henchman Groups are a kind of Villain Group, so each Henchman Group counts towards this number. Don't count cards turned face down by Soulbind. You can't count cards that have no Villain Group that some special rule may have put into your Victory Pile, including Tactics, Bystanders, Master Strikes, Scheme Twists, or Heroes that were turned into Villains.

Ultron Infinity

Ultron's abilities can let him get multiple Empowered abilities. He counts each of them separately. So if he gets two "Empowered by  abilities, he will get **+2**  for each  card in the HQ. If he collects all the Infinity Stones, Ultron Infinity can get **+∞** . This gives him infinity Attack! This means that no amount of normal  will be able to beat him. Depending on your Heroes, you might still have a sliver of hope to defeat him with the **∞**  made by Gamora's "Infinity Crusher" or with other occasional Hero cards that say "Defeat the Mastermind once" without using  points. The best plan is to defeat Ultron before he masters all of the Infinity Stones and goes infinite!

Details on Specific Card Types

S.H.I.E.L.D. Cards Are Heroes

All S.H.I.E.L.D. Agents, Troopers, and Officers are Hero cards. Most normal S.H.I.E.L.D. Heroes have no Hero Class and are the color grey. If a card effect says to "KO one of your Heroes," you can KO one of your S.H.I.E.L.D. cards (and that's usually a good idea).

Bystanders

Some card effects tell you to “rescue a Bystander.” This means **take the top Bystander from the Bystander Deck** and put it into your Victory Pile. This represents saving Bystanders that are trapped or in danger from all the chaos and destruction. Each Bystander in your Victory Pile gives you additional Victory Points at the end of the game. (See page 10 for more details on how Bystanders can be captured by Villains.)

- **Important:** Cards that say “rescue a Bystander” **can’t** save Bystanders captured by specific Villains in the city – you have to fight those Villains to save those Bystanders.
- Some “Special Bystanders” say you get an extra effect “When you rescue this Bystander.” This could happen because you fought a Villain holding that Bystander or because you rescued that Bystander from the Bystander Deck.
- Some Schemes turn some Bystander cards into Villains and say “When you fight one, rescue it as a Bystander.” When you rescue one this way, do any “When you rescue this Bystander...” effects it has. It counts as a Bystander in your Victory Pile, not a Villain.

Wounds

Some card effects make you gain Wound cards, representing your team getting hurt especially badly. When a player gains a Wound, take a card from the Wound Deck and put it into that player’s discard pile. Wounds don’t have any Attack or Recruit, so when you draw Wounds in your hand, your hand is weaker than normal.

- Some card effects let you KO your Wounds. Some cards may even turn Wounds to your benefit.
- Wound cards aren’t Heroes. Wounds don’t have a Hero Class or color, not even grey. If a card tells you to “KO one of your Heroes,” you can’t KO a Wound, since Wounds aren’t Heroes. However, if a card says “KO one of your cards,” then you can KO a Wound, since Wound cards are still cards.

Healing Wounds

If you have one or more Wounds in your hand, you can use the ability written on the Wound card: *“Healing: If you don’t recruit or fight anything on your turn, you may KO all the Wounds from your hand.”*

- **If you use this Healing ability, you can’t recruit or fight any kinds of cards either before or after you use the Healing ability.**
- Healing is often worthwhile if you have at least two Wounds in your hand, and/or if Wounds were weakening your hand enough that your turn wouldn’t have been very good anyway.
- You use this Healing ability directly from your hand, so you don’t “play” the Wound cards. Wound cards can’t be played.
- When you have Wounds, it’s okay to play the rest of the cards in your hand and use some abilities like “draw a card” to see how your turn develops and how many Attack and Recruit you would have. Then you can decide whether to use the “Healing” ability on the Wounds, or whether to fight and recruit.

Running out of Officers, Bystanders, or Wounds

If the S.H.I.E.L.D. Officer, Bystander, or Wound Deck runs out, the game continues as normal. If a player would gain one of these cards, and there aren’t any more left in the appropriate deck, then you just don’t gain that card and the game continues. Don’t take extra copies out of the KO pile.

- If all the cards in the Wound Deck are used up, the Heroes have taken enough punishment, and the game is probably close to complete!

Special Abilities on Cards

Special abilities on cards can override the rules of the game.

- Some cards tell “each player” to do something. In those cases, the player whose turn it is does it first, then go in clockwise order.
- If a card tells you to do something, and you can’t do all of it, then do as much as you can. For example: if a card tells you to KO two Bystanders from your Victory Pile, and you only have one Bystander, then KO that Bystander and move on.
- If a card effect calls for a choice, and it’s not obvious who should make the choice, then the player whose turn it is makes the choice.

Revealing a Card

“Reveal a card” just means show the other players that you have it. You can reveal a card from your hand or you can reveal a card in front of you that you have already played this turn. “Revealing” a card doesn’t automatically play or discard that card. You can reveal the same card multiple times in a turn if necessary.

- Say a card effect tells you to “Reveal a  card or gain a Wound.” If you have a  card in your hand or that you’ve played this turn, you could reveal it to stop the Wound, or you could choose not to reveal it and just gain the Wound instead. In rare cases where you have lots of cards that benefit from gaining Wounds, you might prefer to just gain the Wound.
- Essentially, if a card says “do A or do B,” you can choose either option that you can actually do. You can’t choose an option that you can’t do.

“Reveal the Top Card of Your Deck”

If a card or keyword effect says to reveal the top card of your deck, and it doesn’t say where to put that card afterwards, then that card stays where it was, face down on top of your deck.

“Each Hero You Played This Turn”

This phrase only counts cards you have already played this turn, not other cards still in your hand.

“Your Heroes” & “Heroes You Have”

These phrases include both the cards you have played this turn **and** the cards in your hand. The Heroes in your deck and discard pile don’t count.

Advanced Card Interaction Details

There’s no need to read this section unless you have a particular rules question that you need help figuring out.

Printed

A card’s “Printed  ” means the number literally printed inside the card’s big  icon. Ignore any + or * symbols or special abilities on that card. Likewise, effects that say “If that card has a  icon...” check whether that card has a big  icon in its lower-left corner – they don’t care whether or not the card has any small  icons in its text box.

Cards That Don’t Have a Number

If a card effect needs to know a number from a card, and that card doesn’t have that kind of number, use 0. If some Scheme shuffles Scheme Twists into your deck for some reason, a Scheme Twist doesn’t have a cost, so its cost is considered to be 0.

Henchmen Are Villains. Masterminds Are Not Villains.

- Henchman Villain cards are indeed Villains.
- Henchman Groups are likewise a kind of Villain Group, That said, when a Scheme says to add an extra Villain Group, it means a standard 8-card Villain Group (not a Henchman Group), unless it specifically says to add Henchmen.
- Masterminds are so powerful that they don't count as mere "Villains." Card effects that affect Villains don't affect Masterminds unless they explicitly say they affect Masterminds.
- The word "Enemy" includes both Villains and Masterminds.

A Villain Gets -

Some cards reduce Villains' Attack. If a Villain's Attack goes to 0, you can defeat that Villain without spending any Attack. A Villain's Attack can't go below 0.

Villains Escaping with Captured Heroes

Some Villains like Party Skrull can capture Heroes. If a Villain escapes with captured Heroes, that doesn't cause any discarding. The captured Heroes just stay in the Escape Pile.

Schemes that Count "Escaped Villains"

Some Schemes say things like "Evil Wins: When 4 Villains per player have escaped." These count only the Villain cards **currently** in the Escape Pile.

- This includes other card types like Master Strikes or Bystanders that were turned into Villains by card effects and escaped the city as Villains.
- This doesn't count Villains that escape the city and are immediately put somewhere besides the Escape Pile.

Card Effects Causing Villains to Enter or Escape the City Instantly

Sometimes a card effect causes a Villain to escape instantly from the city, without the normal process of being pushed by another Villain. If this happens, the Villain escapes from whatever space it's in, without pushing any other Villains out of the city.

- The escaping Villain does all normal Escape effects as if it had escaped normally, including KO'ing a Hero from the HQ and causing each player to discard if it escaped with any number of Bystanders.
- Likewise, if a card effect causes a Villain to enter the city at an unusual time, and/or in an unusual city space, that Villain still does its Ambush ability.
- Note: Villains only do their Ambush ability when they enter the city. If a card effect makes a Villain appear someplace besides the city (like in the HQ, in front of a player, etc.) then it won't do its Ambush.



Adjusting Difficulty

Some play groups like an easier challenge when introducing new or younger players or if the Masterminds have been winning too much. Other groups like to face tougher challenges. One way to adjust the difficulty level is choosing which cards to use in your next game:

- **Mastermind:** Some Masterminds are intentionally easier or harder to defeat. This is the easiest way to adjust difficulty. Many elements play a role in overall Mastermind power level. Learning which Masterminds are easier and stronger (and the best ways to fight each one) is part of the game!
- **Epic Mastermind side:** If you are feeling especially confident and ambitious, you can flip over any of the Masterminds in this set to their “Epic Mastermind” side, which has more dangerous special abilities, Master Strikes, and Attack numbers. These are not for the faint of heart!
- **Scheme:** Likewise, you will find that some Schemes are easier or harder to defeat. Some Schemes are especially difficult in combination with certain Masterminds or Villain Groups. Again, finding out which Schemes are hardest and the best ways to beat each Scheme combined with each Mastermind is part of the game.
- **Villain Groups:** Some Villain Groups are intentionally tougher than others. For example, the Rival Overlords are especially tough, while the Intergalactic Party Animals are much easier. The VP of the Villains in the group is the clearest signal for which Villain Groups are harder.

Making the Game Harder

If you are seeking even greater challenges, you can try increasing the Mastermind’s base Attack or increasing the number of Scheme Twists in the Villain Deck. A small upgrade here can have a big impact!

Optional Harder End Game: “Final Blow”

Some players like to play with an optional rule that after the Mastermind has been fought 4 times and has no more face down Tactics, a player must still fight the Mastermind card itself in a 5th, final fight to put the Mastermind card into their Victory Pile and win the game. This variation makes the game harder and a bit longer. If your group wants to use Final Blow, it’s best to make that clear at the start.

Making the Game Easier

If you want to give newer or younger players a boost to help them compete with veteran players, or if you want some help in challenging an especially powerful or Epic Mastermind:

- You can replace some number of the S.H.I.E.L.D. Agents with S.H.I.E.L.D. Officers in those players’ starting decks.
- Or you can give them a larger hand size, like 7 or 8 cards.
- Or you can agree to reduce the Mastermind’s Attack by some fixed number throughout the game.

Solo Mode:

You can also play *Legendary*® as a single player, competing to defeat each Mastermind & Scheme combination while earning the highest scores you can. This revised solo mode overrides and replaces the solo rules in earlier core sets like the Core Set 1st Edition, *Legendary*®: Dark City, *Legendary*®: Villains, & *Legendary*®: Marvel Studios Phase 1.

Solo Setup

Hero Deck: Use 3 random Heroes, 42 cards in total

Villain Deck:

- **1 Villain Group** (of 8 cards)
 - Note: In solo mode, ignore the Mastermind's "Always Leads" ability.
- **2 Henchman cards** from the same random Henchman Group
 - **In addition, set aside 2 additional cards from that same Henchman Group.** Those 2 Henchmen enter the city at the very beginning of your first turn, right before you play the normal card from the Villain Deck for your first turn. (They enter the city one at a time, doing any Ambush ability before the next one enters.)
 - Do not use the remaining 6 cards from that Henchman Group. (If a Scheme says to add an extra Henchman Group, use all 10 Henchmen from that extra group unless it tells you to use another number.)
- **1 Bystander** (taken randomly from the Bystander Deck)
- **5 Master Strikes**
- **Scheme Twists** (The normal number listed on the Scheme)

Extra Scheme Twist Effect

- **Whenever you complete a Scheme Twist effect, choose a Hero from the HQ that costs 6 or less and put it on the bottom of the Hero Deck.**
 - This helps you avoid Heroes you don't want and helps you craft a more focused personal strategy. Without this rule and without other players taking cards from the HQ, you would be stuck recruiting most of the cards that the Hero Deck randomly served up to you.
 - **Note:** Some Scheme Twists say things like "Play two cards from the Villain Deck," which can cause even more Scheme Twists to be played. No matter how many Twists end up occurring in the same turn, only put one Hero from the HQ onto the bottom of the Hero Deck. This avoids you having to remember how many Twists happened then tucking away multiple Heroes in a row.

There is no extra effect after a Master Strike.

"Each Other Player"

In solo mode, when a Villain, Mastermind, or Mastermind Tactic tells "each other player" to do something, do it yourself. (Don't do this for "each other player" effects on Hero cards.)

Mastermind Abilities & Specific Villain Groups

Since there is only 1 Villain Group in a 1 player game, ignoring "Always Leads" ensures that the Villain Groups which aren't "Always Led" by any Mastermind still show up sometimes in solo mode. This also adds variety to different games against the same Mastermind.

Some Masterminds have special abilities and Tactics linked to the specific Villains that they usually "Always Lead." In solo mode, if you don't use the group that your Mastermind usually "Always Leads," then apply that ability to the corresponding Villain Group or Henchman Group that you are using instead.

Solo Scoring

If you win the game, add up your Victory Points and subtract these penalties:

- -3 for each Scheme Twist that was played (and isn't in the Villain Deck).
- -1 for each Villain in the Escape Pile.
- -1 for each Bystander in the Escape Pile.

Write down your scores and which Heroes, Mastermind, and Scheme you used. Compete against yourself, your friends, or the many *Legendary*® solo challenge groups on board game websites or social media groups to get better scores against that Mastermind and Scheme with the same or different Heroes!

Alternate Solo Mode: Simulating Multiple Players

Another way to play *Legendary*® solo is to simulate two (or more) players, and you play each of them. This lets you play the game without any solo mode special rules.

Hero Types

Hero Classes / Colors

A card's color is shown in the Hero Class icon in the card's upper left, and also in the color of the card's border. (Each Hero has a "Rare" card with no border, but you can still see that card's color by checking the Hero Class icon in its upper left.) Hero Class and color are the same thing except that there is a sixth color, grey, for cards with no Hero Class.



Strength Heroes (Green) include Heroes with raw physical power, but also Heroes with strength of will, determination, and strong leadership.



Instinct Heroes (Yellow) use savagery and quick reflexes to dominate combats. Some Instinct Heroes use superhuman senses to get an edge on their opponents.



Covert Heroes (Red) include Heroes using trickery and deception to outwit their foes. Some Covert Heroes also plan clever maneuvers or use Superpowers to gain subtle advantages.



Tech Heroes (Black) include Heroes using advanced weaponry, incredible gadgets, brilliant inventions, or next-generation science.



Ranged Heroes (Blue) unleash massive firepower. This includes bows, projectiles, energy beams, elemental powers, and mental assaults.

Basic Heroes (Grey) include all the starting S.H.I.E.L.D. Heroes and S.H.I.E.L.D. Officers. They all count as Heroes, though they don't quite get the job done as well as high-flying Superheroes.

Hero Teams

Most Hero cards have a Team icon in their upper-left corner. Superpower abilities or other special effects sometimes trigger on Team icons instead of Hero Classes.



Guardians of the Multiverse: This unlikely group of Heroes was hand-picked by Uatu the Watcher to confront threats that could unravel every parallel universe at once.



S.H.I.E.L.D.: The "Strategic Hazard Intervention Espionage Logistics Directorate" is a clandestine paramilitary and spy organization led by Director Nick Fury. It works behind the scenes to stop Superpowered Villains before they get out of hand.

Game Contents

Rulebook, playmat, dividers, and 350 game cards:

- 8 Heroes, each with 14 cards (112 cards)
 - (Each Hero has 1 rare, 2 uncommons (2 copies of each), and 3 commons (3 copies of each))
- 5 Villain Groups of 8 cards each (40 cards)
- 3 Henchman Groups of 10 cards each (30 cards)
- 4 Double-Sided Epic Masterminds (20 cards: 4 Mastermind cards and 16 Mastermind Tactics)
- 40 S.H.I.E.L.D. Agents
- 20 S.H.I.E.L.D. Troopers
- 8 S.H.I.E.L.D. Officers
- 30 Bystanders (25 Normal Bystanders and 1 each of Scott Lang's Head, Happy Hogan, Howard the Duck, Howard Stark, and Pepper Potts.)
- 30 Wounds
- 4 different Schemes
- 11 Scheme Twists
- 5 Master Strikes

Credits

Game Design, Card Design, Rulebook: Devin Low

Sr. Brand Manager: Travis Rhea

Assoc. Brand Manager: Corrine Deng

Director of Game Development: Bubby Johanson

Sr. Product Manager: Mark Shaunessy

Product Manager: Rob Ford

Product Development Coordinator: Zack Stevens

Graphic Design: Krista Timberlake

Project Managers: Danny Montejo, Jeffrey Kulp

Community Coordinator: Richard Berg

VP of Production & Logistics: Suzanne Lombardi

President, Upper Deck Company: Jason Masherah

Playtesters: Mark Balleza, Keith Bingham, Kyle Bingham, JR Bontrager, Emily Cross, Michael Green, Monty Hill, Corey Mease, Eric Persons, Aaron Sirois, Jason Walker, Alex Wigger



QUICK REFERENCE GUIDE

SETUP

- Each player shuffles a personal deck of **8 S.H.I.E.L.D. Agents** and **4 S.H.I.E.L.D. Troopers** and draws 6 cards from their deck.
- Put the **S.H.I.E.L.D. Officer, Bystander, and Wound Decks** on the playmat in the appropriate spaces. Decks of all identical cards can stay face up. Decks containing different cards should be shuffled face down.
- Pick 1 **Mastermind** at random, and put them on the playmat, with their **4 Mastermind Tactics** face down underneath them in random order.

VILLAIN DECK

- Pick 1 **Scheme** at random. Follow its **“Setup”** instructions. Use the number of **Scheme Twists** it specifies to start the Villain Deck.
- Add **5 Master Strikes** to the Villain Deck.
- Add this many **Villain Groups, Henchman Groups, and Bystanders** to the Villain Deck. Be sure to include the group that this Mastermind **“Always Leads.”** Shuffle the Villain Deck

Players	Villain Groups	Henchman Groups	Bystanders	Heroes
1	1	1* (2 cards in deck, 2 cards in city)	1	3
2	2	1	2	5
3	3	1	8	5
4	4	2	8	5
5	5	2	16	6

- ***In 1-player solo games only:** Add only two cards from the chosen Henchman Group to the Villain Deck. Two more cards from that same Henchman Group enter the city before your first turn. (See page 23 for more details on solo mode.)
- **In 4 and 5-player games only:** there is a **“Warmup Round”** where on each player’s very first turn, that player does not play a card from the Villain Deck.

HERO DECK

- Randomly select **the listed number of Heroes**. Shuffle their cards together to make the Hero Deck.
- Put 5 cards from the Hero Deck into the HQ, face up.

ON YOUR TURN

1. Play the top card of the Villain Deck.
2. Play cards from your hand, using them to fight and recruit.
3. Discard your hand and draw 6 new cards.

